

MODULE 4: CASE STUDIES & CAPSTONE DEFENSE

Interactive 3-Hour Rhythm

Session 4.4: Final Capstone Defense

Longitudinal company defense, financial reconciliation audit, and executive board presentations.

PART 1 (LECTURE)

60 Minutes

PART 2 (LAB PRACTICE)

60 Minutes

PART 3 (EXECUTIVE MEMO)

60 Minutes

STANDARD

Audited SEC Filings

Learning Objectives & Executive Overview

Clear conceptual grounding for undergraduate and graduate business students.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Goals

What You Will Master Today

- **Theoretical Mastery:** Evaluate seminal literature and analytical frameworks governing platform competition.
- **Empirical Rigor:** Reconcile management strategic claims with legally audited statutory filings.
- **Data Modeling:** Execute spreadsheet calculations with explicit coordinates and formula logic.
- **Executive Formulation:** Deliver structured board-level recommendations resolving complex trade-offs.

PLATFORM STRATEGY SYNTHESIS

Vocabulary

Key Topical Foundations

- **Comprehensive Framework:** Integrating network effects, envelopment, take rates.
- **Audit Trail Standard:** Every model cell and claim linked to primary statutory filings.
- **Board Presentation:** Executive-level delivery of 5-year strategic turning point.
- **Micro-Examples:** Board Q&A defense, reconciliation appendices, margin models.

Theoretical Foundations: Platform Strategy Synthesis

Rigorous analytical frameworks and literature benchmarks.

THEORETICAL ARCHITECTURE

Literature

Seminal Framework Insights

- **Comprehensive Framework:** Integrating network effects, envelopment, take rates.
- **Audit Trail Standard:** Every model cell and claim linked to primary statutory filings.
- **Board Presentation:** Executive-level delivery of 5-year strategic turning point.
- **Micro-Examples:** Board Q&A defense, reconciliation appendices, margin models.

STRATEGIC APPLICATION

Analysis

Business Model Mechanics

- **Capstone Requirement:** Comprehensive 5-year longitudinal study of chosen public platform.
- **Strategic Inflection:** Defending key corporate acquisition, pricing pivot, or cloud shift.
- **Audited Math Defense:** Live on-screen spreadsheet formula verification during defense.
- **Executive Standards:** 100% compliance with zero emojis & zero em dashes rules.

STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY

Longitudinal company defense, financial reconciliation audit, and executive board presentations.

Enterprise Case Dissection: Capstone Defense Case

Historical case evidence and multi-year corporate trajectory analysis.

CORPORATE DYNAMICS

Timeline

Market Conditions & Strategic Moves

- **Capstone Requirement:** Comprehensive 5-year longitudinal study of chosen public platform.
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ANALYTICAL FOCUS

Evidence

Operational & Financial Findings

- **Evaluation Rubric:** Auditing classmate's term project model & slide presentation.
- **Filing Citations:** Verifying 3 random metrics against cited 10-K report pages.
- **Style Audit:** Confirming 100% absence of emojis, em dashes, and unlinked math.
- **Sign-Off Checklist:** Entering auditor sign-off confirming full course compliance.

Lab Dataset & Empirical Metrics: Applied Excel Lab

Reconciling corporate filings with explicit spreadsheet formulas.

SPREADSHEET MODELING

Lab Spec

Data Metrics & Formulas

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MANAGEMENT DILEMMA

Decision Lab

Strategic Tension

- **12-Minute Defense:** Delivering executive strategic presentation on public platform.
- **Turning Point Thesis:** Defending the single most pivotal strategic choice in 5 years.
- **Executive Q&A:** 5-minute interrogation defending spreadsheet formulas on screen.
- **Final Portfolio:** Submission of reconciled Excel model and executive slide deck.

Executive Problem Solving: Executive Lab

Framing complex management dilemmas and evaluating corporate trade-offs.

EXECUTIVE CHALLENGE

Dilemma

Corporate Strategic Tension

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EVALUATION RUBRIC

Requirements

Board-Level Deliverable

- **Actionable Recommendation:** Formulate a concrete 3-bullet decision brief for senior leadership.
- **Quantitative Defense:** Support recommendations using audited financial metrics from the lab spreadsheet.
- **Risk Mitigation:** Address channel friction, partner resistance, or competitive retaliation.
- **Implementation Timeline:** Define immediate 90-day execution milestones.

Lab Transition: 120-Minute Hands-On Execution

Transitioning from lecture observation to hands-on data manipulation and strategic decision-making.

EXERCISE 1: FOUNDATIONAL PRACTICE

60 Min Lab

Applied Excel Lab

Hands-on spreadsheet protocol using audited historical numbers:

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EXERCISE 2+: ADVANCED PROBLEM SOLVING

60 Min Memo

Executive Lab

Applied scenario analysis, trade-off evaluation, and executive brief:

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